HOW CITIES ARE ORGANISED

For many people, cities can appear to be confusing and disorganised places – not for geographers, though. Geographers identify patterns in the way areas and features of cities are organised. These patterns bring a sense of order to these complex places. Like a jigsaw puzzle, cities are made up of different pieces that, together, make up a distinctive landscape, including **residential zones, commercial zones, industrial zones** and **green zones**.

Although every city is unique, they all share certain characteristics. For example, tall buildings tend to be located near the centre of every city, because land there is expensive. Land is usually cheaper near the edges of every city, so that is where people tend to live.

By mapping the main land uses in a range of cities it is possible to identify similar patterns. Some geographers have tried to explain these patterns by developing models that illustrate these patterns. These are called **urban models.** In this activity, you will explore the **Multiple Nuclei Model.**

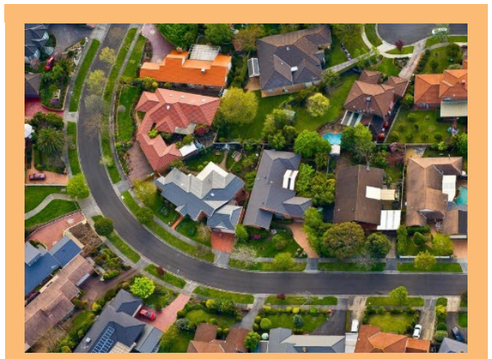


Source: Oxford University Press



The **Central Business District (CBD)** is generally the busiest part of the city. Because lots of people and businesses compete for space, land prices are high, so developers build tall buildings to maximise the available space.

What is the postcode for Melbourne's CBD?



Residential Zones are typically the largest area of any city and comprise mostly of the housing. These areas also include facilities, such as hospitals and schools, for the people who live there.

From the map, what do you notice about residential zones as compared to other zones?



Commercial Zones are made up of retail and hospitality businesses. They are usually located on major roads. These might be large shopping centres or smaller, local shopping strips.

Name three commercial zones that you frequent in Melbourne.



Industrial Zones encompass factories, mills and warehouses. They often located near important transport links (such as ports, freeways and rail lines) but as far away as possible from residential areas.

Why do you think industrial zones are typically located away from residential areas?



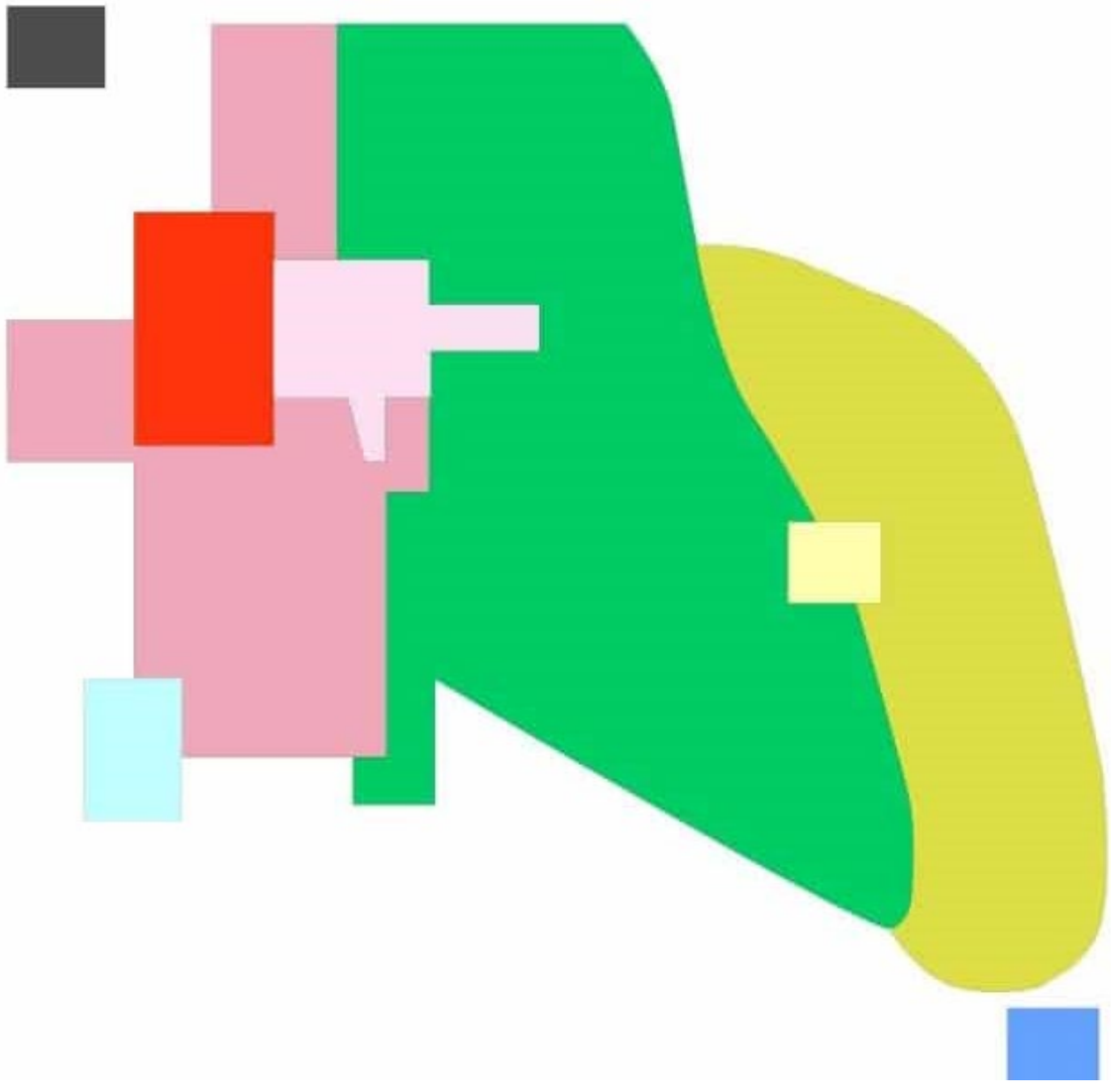
Green Zones are defined by parkland and nature areas They offer people living in cities sporting and recreation opportunities. They are also essential for ensuring that native plant and animal populations remain healthy.

Identify three important green areas in Melbourne.

MULTIPLE NUCLEI MODEL

In 1945, Harris and Ullman presented the **Multiple Nuclei Model** as a way to explain how cities develop to form the shapes they do. They argued that, while a city might begin with a single CBD, over the time these key activities scatter to other parts of the city. These scattered activities act as smaller CBD themselves, called a **nuclei**, which gain importance and grow in size and start, influencing the growth of the area around them.

The diagram below shows a generic example of a Multiple Nuclei Model where the location of the business areas (or places where people work) affecting the location of the residential zones.



Using the map of Melbourne and your own knowledge, suggest somewhere in Melbourne that matches each of the zones in the Multiple Nuclei Model. The first one has been done for you.

Central Business District

Melbourne CBD/City (3000)

Light Manufacturing

Outlying Business District

Low Income Residential

Medium Income Residential

High Income Residential

Commuter Residential

Heavy Manufacturing

Industrial Suburb